

Question 34 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Analyse how HRD practices can be aligned with organisational strategy in a rapidly changing organisation.

Answer

Rapid change (markets, technology, structure) requires HRD that is agile and tightly coupled to strategy.

1. **Continuous strategy–competency translation:** Each strategic shift should update competency maps quickly.
2. **Shorter diagnosis cycles:** Frequent TNA and pulse climate surveys rather than once-in-three-years studies.
3. **Flexible learning:** Blended, just-in-time, on-the-job and e-learning instead of only long residential courses.
4. **Change and OD capability:** HRD facilitates restructuring, new teams and culture, not only skill training.
5. **Talent mobility:** Career systems allow lateral moves and project roles, not rigid ladders.
6. **Line partnership:** Business leaders and HRD jointly review capability risks in strategy meetings.
7. **Let-go of obsolete practices:** Drop training and appraisal items that no longer match strategy.
8. **Evaluate on adaptability:** Judge HRD by speed of capability building and change readiness, not by number of programmes.

Conclusion. Alignment in a fast-changing context is an ongoing process of translating strategy into people systems that can themselves change quickly.